



The life cycle of a plant

Flowering plants may have a life span of just months, or many years. A poppy will germinate, flower, set seed, and die within a year and is known as an annual plant. Other flowering plants live for several years, building up the food reserves they need and storing it. These are called perennial plants. The harsher the climate, the longer it can take for a plant to complete its life cycle.

Late bloomer

High in the cold Andes Mountains of South America, the queen of the Andes plant grows very slowly. It takes over 80 years to bloom and grows a spike nearly 30 ft (10 m) tall, with up to 30,000 flowers, dwarfing the surrounding plants. After shedding millions of seeds, it dies.

